

TCG Distribution Research — Canada & North America

Big Picture

The trading card and hobby distribution space is surprisingly concentrated. Most major brands like Wizards of the Coast, Pokémon, and Bandai do not distribute directly to stores. Instead, they work through approved distributors that handle warehousing, allocation, logistics, and retailer relationships.

A few companies appear repeatedly across all three brands, especially Universal Distribution, which suggests they are one of the dominant players in Canada.

The space also appears to be tightening up, with larger publishers wanting more control over supply chains and allocations.

Wizards of the Coast / Hasbro

Wizards of the Coast (Magic: The Gathering, D&D;) operates under Hasbro.

Main contacts:

- John Hight — President of Wizards of the Coast
<https://www.linkedin.com/in/jhight/>

- Hasbro Canada B2B Support
B2BCustServ@hasbro.com

Current Canadian distributors:

- Asmodee
- Universal Distribution
- Grosnor Distribution (new addition as of March 2026)

Grosnor appears important because they were recently added to the Canadian distribution network, which could indicate Hasbro is expanding or diversifying its distribution relationships.

Grosnor Contacts:

- David Yeates — dyeates@grosnor.com
 - Rob Roche — rroche@grosnor.com
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Bandai

Bandai's distribution appears split between hobby/model products and trading card games.

Main hobby distributor in Canada:

- PLAMOD Distributors INC
Coquitlam, BC

support@plamod.com

Main contact:

- Won Ki (Sean) Lee

Card game distribution:

- Universal Distribution Canada

Vancouver contact: oliver@universaldist.com

Pokémon

Pokémon appears to have the tightest and most controlled distribution system of the three.

TPCi (The Pokémon Company International) manages Pokémon outside of Asia and operates out of Bellevue, Washington.

Canada falls under the North American operation.

Authorized Canadian distributors:

- Universal Distribution
- Echo Brands
- Prince Distribution

Key contact:

- Leon Suh — COO/CFO
- l.suh@pokemon.com

Official reseller information:

<https://support.pokemon.com/hc/en-us/articles/360001004653-Pokémon-Trading-Card-Game-Resellers>

Key Takeaways

1. Universal Distribution keeps showing up everywhere.
They likely have strong retailer relationships, warehousing infrastructure, and publisher trust.
2. Grosnor's recent addition to Hasbro's network may signal an opening or strategic shift in the market.
3. Pokémon appears much harder to break into directly because they seem to be increasing control over distribution.
4. The most realistic path into this space is probably:
 - acquiring an existing distributor,
 - operating fulfillment/logistics,
 - or consolidating smaller regional operators.

Trying to start a brand-new distributor from scratch would likely be extremely difficult.

Potential Opportunities

Potential opportunities could include:

- Canadian regional fulfillment
- Warehousing & logistics
- Independent hobby store distribution
- Consolidation of smaller distributors
- Western Canada specialty distribution
- Event/convention supply logistics

This industry is heavily relationship-driven, but operational strength and logistics capability still matter a lot.
